JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff BI Analyst with 12 years of experience building data solutions that drive business decisions. I specialise in designing data warehouses, developing complex analytics platforms, and mentoring junior analysts. I've worked across retail, financial services, and healthcare, and I enjoy the challenge of turning messy data into actionable insights that actually get used by the business.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff BI Analyst

Meridian Analytics Solutions

www.meridiananalytics.io

Birmingham, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led the redesign of our enterprise data warehouse, reducing query times by 60% and cutting infrastructure costs by £180k annually through optimised indexing and fact table restructuring. Established governance frameworks and data quality processes that improved upstream data accuracy from 91% to 97%. Mentored a team of 4 junior analysts, conducting weekly technical reviews and delivering training on dimensional modelling and SQL optimisation techniques. Designed and implemented a real-time dashboard suite in Tableau that replaced 15 manual Excel reporting processes, saving the finance team approximately 8 hours per week.

Senior BI Analyst

Pinnacle Retail Group

www.pinnacleretail.co.uk

Birmingham, United Kingdom

June 2017 - February 2021

Developed a predictive inventory analytics model using Python and machine learning that reduced excess stock by 18% across 240 stores while maintaining service levels. Migrated legacy reporting infrastructure from Cognos to Power BI, consolidating 47 separate reports into 8 interactive dashboards used by 120+ business users. Built ETL pipelines in SQL Server Integration Services to ingest daily transaction data from 350 point-of-sale systems, ensuring data freshness within 2 hours of store close. Partnered with merchandising teams to create performance analytics that identified underperforming product lines, contributing to a £2.3m improvement in gross margin.

BI Analyst

Whitmore Financial Services

www.whitmorefs.net

Leeds, United Kingdom

September 2012 - May 2017

Designed and built a loan performance analytics platform from scratch, supporting credit risk assessment and regulatory reporting for a £1.2bn loan portfolio. Created complex DAX calculations in Power Pivot to model customer lifetime value, helping the acquisition team refine targeting strategies and reduce customer acquisition cost by 12%. Documented data lineage and created data dictionaries for 8 core data marts, establishing a

foundation for compliance with regulatory audit requirements. Produced monthly executive dashboards and ad-hoc analyses that informed strategic decisions on product pricing and market expansion.

EDUCATION

MSc Business Intelligence

University of Birmingham

Graduated August 2012

BSc Mathematics

University of Warwick

Graduated June 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Data Warehousing: Dimensional modelling, Kimball methodology, star schema design, slowly changing dimensions, fact table architecture

Business Intelligence Tools: Tableau, Power BI, Looker, Cognos

Databases: SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Snowflake, Oracle

Programming Languages: SQL, Python, DAX, M

ETL and Data Integration: SQL Server Integration Services (SSIS), Talend, Informatica, Apache Airflow

Data Analysis: Advanced Excel, statistical analysis, predictive modelling, time series forecasting

Cloud Platforms: AWS Redshift, Azure Data Warehouse, Google BigQuery

Version Control: Git, GitHub, Azure DevOps

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Professional Memberships: Institute of Analytics Professionals, UK

Languages: English (native), French (conversational)

Certifications: Microsoft Certified Data Analyst, Tableau Desktop Specialist